Group Cohomology

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Contents

1 Definitions and resolutions **1**

2 Low degree cohomology, group extensions **10**
2.1 First cohomology 10
2.2 Second cohomology 11
2.3 Group extensions by presentations 16

Lecture 1

1 Definitions and resolutions

Let G be a group.

Definition 1.1 (integral group ring)
The *integral group ring* $\mathbb{Z}G$ has elements being formal sums

$$\sum n_g g$$

for $n_g \in \mathbb{Z}, g \in G$, and only finitely many n_g are non-zero. This is a free abelian group under addition, i.e.

$$\left(\sum m_g g\right) + \left(\sum n_g g\right) = \sum (m_g + n_g) g$$

and we have multiplication

$$\left(\sum m_h h\right)\left(\sum n_k k\right) = \sum_g \left(\sum_{hk=g} m_h n_k\right) g$$

This is the associative ring underlying the integral representation theory of G. We will write $1 = 1e$ for the multiplicative identity in G.

Definition 1.2 (module)
A *(left)* $\mathbb{Z}G$*-module* M is an abelian group under addition, and a map

$$\begin{aligned} \mathbb{Z}G \times M &\to M \\ (r, m) &\mapsto rm \end{aligned}$$

such that

1. $r(m+n) = rm + rn$,

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2. $(r_1 + r_2)m = r_1 m + r_2 m$,
3. $(r_1 r_2)m = r_1(r_2 m)$,
4. $1m = m$

A module is *trivial* if $gm = m$ for all $g \in G$, $m \in M$. We say *the trivial module* is $\mathbb{Z}$ with trivial action $gm = m$. A *free $\mathbb{Z}G$-module* on X is formal sums

$$\sum r_x x$$

for $r_x \in \mathbb{Z}G, x \in X$, and finitely many r_x non-zero. We will write $\mathbb{Z}G\{X\}$ for this.

Submodules and *quotient modules* are defined as we would expect.

Definition 1.3 ($\mathbb{Z}G$-map)

An *$\mathbb{Z}G$-map (or morphism)* $\alpha : M_1 \to M_2$ is a map of abelian groups, with

$$\alpha(rm_1) = r\alpha(m_1)$$

for $r \in \mathbb{Z}G, m_1 \in M_1$.

Example 1.4

The *augmentation map* is

$$\varepsilon : \mathbb{Z}G \to \mathbb{Z}$$
$$\sum n_g g \mapsto \sum n_g$$

where we treat $\mathbb{Z}G$ as a left $\mathbb{Z}G$-module, and $\mathbb{Z}$ as the trivial module. This is a $\mathbb{Z}G$ map, and it is also a ring homomorphism.

Notation 1.5. Write $\mathrm{Hom}_G(M, N)$ for the set of $\mathbb{Z}G$-maps from $M \to N$, with pointwise addition.

Example 1.6

If we regard $\mathbb{Z}G$ as a left $\mathbb{Z}G$-module, then

$$\mathrm{Hom}_G(\mathbb{Z}G, M) \cong M$$

for any left $\mathbb{Z}G$-module M, by sending φ to $\varphi(1)$. This is an isomorphism since

$$\varphi(r) = \varphi(r1) = r\varphi(1)$$

Note that $\mathrm{Hom}_G(\mathbb{Z}G, M)$ is a left $\mathbb{Z}G$-module, with

$$(s\phi)(r) = \phi(rs)$$

In particular,

$$\mathrm{Hom}_G(\mathbb{Z}G, \mathbb{Z}G) \cong \mathbb{Z}G$$

With this, $\varphi \mapsto \varphi(1)$ corresponds to multiplication on the *right* by $\varphi(1)$.

Note that G may not be abelian, so the distinction between left and right modules matters.

Definition 1.7

If $f : M_1 \to M_2$ is a $\mathbb{Z}G$-map, then the dual map is

$$f^* : \mathrm{Hom}_G(M_2, N) \to \mathrm{Hom}_G(M_1, N)$$

for any $\mathbb{Z}G$-module N. This is given by

$$f^*(\varphi) = \varphi \circ f$$

Similarly, if $f : N_1 \to N_2$, then we have

$$f_* : \mathrm{Hom}_G(M, N_1) \to \mathrm{Hom}(M, N_2)$$

with $f_*(\varphi) = f \circ \varphi$.

These are maps of abelian groups, since in general $\mathrm{Hom}_G(M, N)$ doesn't have to be a $\mathbb{Z}G$-module, as we don't have a right action.

Example 1.8 (Prototypical example)

Let $G = \langle t \rangle$ be an infinite cyclic group, and consider the graph Γ with vertices $\{v_i\}_{i\in\mathbb{Z}}$, edges $v_i \leftrightarrow v_{i+1}$. Then G acts on the set V of vertices, by $tv_i = v_{i+1}$, and also on the set E of edges. The action is transitive in both cases. The formal integral sums $\mathbb{Z}V$ and $\mathbb{Z}E$ are $\mathbb{Z}G$-modules, and are free. Fix the edge $e : v_0 \leftrightarrow v_1$. Then we have $\mathbb{Z}G$-maps

$$\begin{aligned} \mathrm{d} : \mathbb{Z}E &\to \mathbb{Z}V \\ e &\mapsto v_1 - v_0 \end{aligned}$$

and also

$$\begin{aligned} \mathbb{Z}V &\to \mathbb{Z} \\ v_0 &\mapsto 1 \end{aligned}$$

This correspond to the augmentation map.

Definition 1.9 (chain complex, exact, homology)

A *chain complex* of $\mathbb{Z}G$-modules is a sequence

$$M_s \xrightarrow{\mathrm{d}_s} M_{s-1} \xrightarrow{\mathrm{d}_{s-1}} \cdots \xrightarrow{\mathrm{d}_{t+1}} M_t$$

of $\mathbb{Z}G$-modules and maps, such that for $t < n < s$, $\mathrm{d}_n \circ \mathrm{d}_{n+1} = 0$. We will write

$$M_\bullet = (M_n, \mathrm{d}_n)_{t\le n\le s}$$

We say that $M_\bullet$ is *exact* at M_n if $\mathrm{im}(\mathrm{d}_{n+1}) = \ker(\mathrm{d}n)$. The sequence is exact if if it exact at all M_n with $t < n < s$.

The *homology* of $M_\bullet$ is given by

$$\begin{aligned} \mathrm{H}_s(M_\bullet) &= \ker(\mathrm{d}s) \\ \mathrm{H}_n(M_\bullet) &= \frac{\ker(\mathrm{d}_n)}{\mathrm{im}(\mathrm{d}_{n+1})} \text{ for } t < n < s \\ \mathrm{H}_t(M_\bullet) &= \mathrm{coker}(\mathrm{d}_{t+1}) \end{aligned}$$

A *short exact sequence* is a chain complex of the form

$$0 \longrightarrow M_1 \xrightarrow{\alpha} M_2 \xrightarrow{\beta} M_3 \longrightarrow 0$$

In our prototypical example, we have a short exact sequence

$$0 \longrightarrow \mathbb{Z}E \longrightarrow \mathbb{Z}V \longrightarrow \mathbb{Z} \longrightarrow 0$$

which corresponds to

$$0 \longrightarrow \mathbb{Z}G \longrightarrow \mathbb{Z}G \longrightarrow \mathbb{Z} \longrightarrow 0$$

where the map $\mathbb{Z}G \to \mathbb{Z}G$ is multiplication on the right by $t-1$.

Definition 1.10 (projective)
A $\mathbb{Z}G$-module P is *projective* if for every surjective $\mathbb{Z}G$-map $\alpha : M_1 \to M_2$, and every $\mathbb{Z}G$-map $\beta : P \to M_2$, there exists $\overline{\beta}$ such that

$$\begin{array}{ccccc} & & & & P \\ & & \overset{\overline{\beta}}{\nearrow} & & \downarrow{\scriptstyle \beta} \\ M_1 & \xrightarrow[\alpha]{} & M_2 & \longrightarrow & 0 \end{array}$$

commutes.

If we have any short exact sequence

$$0 \longrightarrow N \xrightarrow{f} M_1 \xrightarrow{\alpha} M_2 \longrightarrow 0$$

Consider

$$0 \longrightarrow \mathrm{Hom}_G(P, N) \xrightarrow{f_*} \mathrm{Hom}_G(P, M_1) \xrightarrow{\alpha_*} \mathrm{Hom}_G(P, M_2) \longrightarrow 0 \qquad (*)$$

Then P is projective if and only if $(*)$ is exact. Note that in $(*)$, we always have exactness except at $\mathrm{Hom}_G(P, M_2)$.

Lecture 2

Lemma 1.11. Free modules are projective.

Proof. Let $\alpha : M_1 \to M_2$ be a surjective $\mathbb{Z}G$-map, $\beta : \mathbb{Z}G\{X\} \to M_2$. For each $x \in X$, since α is surjective, there exists $m_x \in M_1$ such that $\alpha(m_x) = \beta(x)$. We can then define $\overline{\beta} : \mathbb{Z}G\{X\} \to M_1$, by

$$\sum r_x \cdot x \mapsto \sum r_x \cdot m_x$$

□

Definition 1.12
A *projective (resp. free) resolution of the trivial module* $\mathbb{Z}$ is an exact sequence

$$\cdots \xrightarrow{d_2} P_1 \xrightarrow{d_1} P_0 \xrightarrow{d_0} \mathbb{Z} \longrightarrow 0$$

with all the P_i projective (resp. free).

Example 1.13
When $G = \langle t \rangle$ is infinite cyclic, we have the free resolution

$$0 \longrightarrow \mathbb{Z}G \xrightarrow{\cdot(t-1)} \mathbb{Z}G \xrightarrow{\varepsilon} \mathbb{Z} \longrightarrow 0$$

Example 1.14

If $G = \langle t \rangle$ cyclic of order n. Then

$$\cdots \longrightarrow \mathbb{Z}G \xrightarrow{\alpha} \mathbb{Z}G \xrightarrow{\beta} \mathbb{Z}G \xrightarrow{\alpha} \mathbb{Z}G \xrightarrow{\varepsilon} \mathbb{Z} \longrightarrow 0$$

is a free resolution, where $\alpha(x) = x(t-1)$ and $\beta(x) = x(1 + t + \cdots + t^{n-1})$.

From algebraic topology, if we have a connected simplicial complex X, with $\pi_1(X) = G$, and the universal cover $\widetilde{X}$ is contractible, then we have a free resolution of $\mathbb{Z}$. The point is that the simplicial complex X contains a lot of information about G. We are trying to replicate this algebraically.

For calculation purposes, we're interested in *small resolutions*. For example, where the free modules have small rank. But for theory development purposes, we're wanting general constructions, and such resolutions tend to be large.

Definition 1.15

G is of type FP_n if $\mathbb{Z}$ has a projective resolution

$$\cdots \longrightarrow P_2 \xrightarrow{\mathrm{d}_2} P_1 \xrightarrow{\mathrm{d}_1} P_0 \xrightarrow{\mathrm{d}_0} \mathbb{Z} \longrightarrow 0$$

so that $P_n, \ldots, P_0$ are finitely generated.

G is of type FP_n is $\mathbb{Z}$ has a projective resolution with all P_n finitely generated.

G is of type FP if there exists a projective resolution of $\mathbb{Z}$ with finite length and all P_n are finitely generated. That is, $P_s = 0$ for s sufficiently large.

Example 1.16

$G = \langle t \rangle$ infinite cyclic is of type FP, $G = C_n = \langle t \rangle$ finite cyclic is of type FP_∞.

These are to be regarded as finiteness conditions on the group. The topological version of FP_n (which is called F_n) would be asking for X with $\pi_1(X) = G$, having a finite n-skeleton. Note that these two conditions are not equivalent.

Now lets meet some general constructions. If we have a partial projective resolution

$$P_s \xrightarrow{\mathrm{d}_s} P_{s-1} \longrightarrow \cdots \longrightarrow P_1 \xrightarrow{\mathrm{d}_1} P_0 \xrightarrow{\mathrm{d}_0} \mathbb{Z} \longrightarrow 0$$

Then we can make it longer by setting

$$P_{s+1} = \mathbb{Z}G\{X_{s+1}\}$$

with $X_{s+1} = \ker(\mathrm{d}_s)$, and set

$$\mathrm{d}_{s+1} : \sum r_x x \mapsto \sum r_x x$$

Then

$$P_{s+1} \xrightarrow{\mathrm{d}_{s+1}} P_s \xrightarrow{\mathrm{d}_s} P_{s-1} \longrightarrow \cdots \longrightarrow P_1 \xrightarrow{\mathrm{d}_1} P_0 \xrightarrow{\mathrm{d}_0} \mathbb{Z} \longrightarrow 0$$

is a longer partial projective resolution. To make P_{s+1} smaller, we could take X_{s+1} to be a $\mathbb{Z}G$-generating set for $\ker(\mathrm{d}_s)$. This is particularly useful if $\ker(\mathrm{d}_s)$ is finitely generated.

Continuing this, we can get a (full) projective resolution.

Definition 1.17

The *standard (or bar) resolution of* $\mathbb{Z}$, for any group G, is: Let

$$G^{(n)} = \{[g_1|\ldots|g_n] \mid g_i \in G\}$$

be the set of symbols. In particular, $G^{(0)} = \{[]\}$ Let

$$F_n = \mathbb{Z}G\{G^{(n)}\}$$

be the free module on $G^{(n)}$. The differential is given by

$$\begin{aligned} \mathrm{d}_n[g_1|\dots|g_n] &= g_1[g_2|\dots|g_n] \\ &\quad -[g_1g_2|g_3|\dots|g_n] \\ &\quad +[g_1|g_2g_3|\dots|g_n]+\dots \\ &\quad +(-1)^{n-1}[g_1|\dots|g_{n-1}g_n] \\ &\quad +[g_1|\dots|g_{n-1}] \end{aligned}$$

With this, $\mathrm{d}_{n-1}\mathrm{d}_n = 0$, and we have a chain complex

$$\cdots \longrightarrow F_n \longrightarrow F_{n-1} \longrightarrow \cdots \longrightarrow F_0 \xrightarrow{[]\mapsto 1} \mathbb{Z} \longrightarrow 0$$

Remark 1.18. The bar resolution corresponds to the standard resolution in algebraic topology. Consider $n+1$ tuples G^{n+1}, and form the free abelian group $\mathbb{Z}G^{n+1}$ under addition. G acts on G^{n+1} diagonally, so

$$g\cdot(h_0,\dots,h_n) = (gh_0,\dots,gh_n)$$

So $\mathbb{Z}G^{n+1}$ is a free $\mathbb{Z}G$-module, on the basis of $n+1$ tuples with $g_0 = 1$. Then we have a correspondence

$$[g_1|\dots|g_n] \mapsto (1, g_1, g_1g_2, \dots, g_1\cdots g_n)$$

Note that removing the first entry gives $g_1(1, g_2, g_2g_3, \dots, g_2\cdots g_n)$, and removing the seconc entry in the tuple gives $(1, g_1g_2, g_1g_2g_3, \dots, g_1\cdots g_n)$.

Lemma 1.19. The bar resolution is exact.

Proof. We'll just consider the d_n as maps of abelian groups. F_n has basis $G\times G^{(n)}$ as a free abelian group, and $G\times G^{(n)}$ is the set

$$\{g_0[g_1|\dots|g_n] \mid g_i \in G\}$$

Define $\mathbb{Z}$-linear maps $s_n : F_n \to F_{n+1}$, such that

$$\mathrm{id}_{F_n} = \mathrm{d}_{n+1}s_n + s_{n-1}\mathrm{d}_n \qquad (*)$$

given by

$$s_n(g_0[g_1|\dots|g_n]) = [g_0|\dots|g_n]$$

We can verify that $(*)$ holds on the basis, and so if $x\in\ker(\mathrm{d}_{n+1})$, then

$$x = \mathrm{id}(x) = \mathrm{d}_{n+1}s_n(x) + s_{n-1}\mathrm{d}_n(x) = \mathrm{d}_{n+1}s_n(x) \in \mathrm{im}(\mathrm{d}_{n+1})$$

That is, s_n is a chain homotopy from the identity to zero. □

Corollary 1.20. A finite group is of type FP_∞.

Proof. The bar resolution gives such a resolution. □

Lecture 3

Definition 1.21

Consider a projective resolution

$$\cdots \longrightarrow P_{n+1} \longrightarrow P_n \xrightarrow{d_n} \cdots \longrightarrow P_1 \longrightarrow P_0 \longrightarrow \mathbb{Z} \longrightarrow 0$$

of $\mathbb{Z}$ by $\mathbb{Z}G$-modules. Let M be a (left) $\mathbb{Z}G$-module. Apply the functor $\mathrm{Hom}_G(\cdot, M)$, we get the *dual*

sequence

$$\cdots \longleftarrow \mathrm{Hom}(P_{n+1}, M) \xleftarrow{\mathrm{d}^{n+1}} \mathrm{Hom}(P_n, M) \longleftarrow \cdots \longleftarrow \mathrm{Hom}(P_0, M) \qquad (\dagger)$$

where $\mathrm{d}^n = \mathrm{d}_n^*$. Then the *$n$-th cohomology group* $\mathrm{H}^n(G, M)$ *with coefficients in* M *is:*

$$\mathrm{H}^n(G, M) = \frac{\ker(\mathrm{d}^{n+1})}{\mathrm{im}(\mathrm{d}^n)} \text{ for } n \geq 1$$
$$\mathrm{H}^0(G, M) = \ker(\mathrm{d}^1)$$

Remark 1.22. We have dropped the $\mathbb{Z}$-term in $(\dagger)$.
Also, these cohomology groups are the homology groups of the chain complex

$$C_n = \mathrm{Hom}_G(P_{-n}, M)$$

with $-\infty < n \leq 0$.

Later, we will see that these cohomology groups are independent of the choice of resolution.

Example 1.23

In our prototypical example, $G = \langle t \rangle$ infinite cyclic, we have a projective resolution

$$0 \longrightarrow \mathbb{Z}G \xrightarrow{\mathrm{d}} \mathbb{Z}G \longrightarrow \mathbb{Z} \longrightarrow 0$$

where $\mathrm{d}(x) = x(t-1)$. For $\phi \in \mathrm{Hom}_G(\mathbb{Z}G, M)$, $x \in \mathbb{Z}G$,

$$\mathrm{d}^1(\phi)(x) = \phi(\mathrm{d}_1(x)) = \phi(x(t-1))$$

Moreover, recall $\mathrm{Hom}_G(\mathbb{Z}G, M) \cong M$, where $i(\phi) = \phi(1)$. In particular,

$$\mathrm{d}^1(\phi) \mapsto \mathrm{d}^1\phi(1) = \phi(t-1) = (t-1)\phi(1) = (t-1)i(\phi)$$

In this case, we have

$$0 \longleftarrow M \xleftarrow[(t-1)\cdot]{} M$$

and so

$$\mathrm{H}^0(G, M) = \{m \in M \mid tm = m\} = M^G$$
$$\mathrm{H}^1(G, M) = \frac{M}{(t-1)M} = M_G$$

and $\mathrm{H}^n(G, M) = 0$ otherwise. Here, M^G is the group of *invariants*, the largest submodule with trivial G-action. Conversely, M_G is the *coinvariants*, the largest quotient module with trivial G-action.

Remark 1.24. $\mathrm{H}^0(M, G) = M^G$ is generally true. But $\mathrm{H}^1(M, G) = M_G$ is special behaviour of $G = \langle t \rangle$.
For any group of type FP, we have that $\mathrm{H}^n(G, M) = 0$ for large enough n.

Definition 1.25

G is of *cohomological dimension m over* $\mathbb{Z}$ if there exists an $\mathbb{Z}G$-module M, with

$$\mathrm{H}^m(G, M) \neq 0$$

and $\mathrm{H}^n(G, M') = 0$ for any $\mathbb{Z}G$-module M', and $n > m$.

Note that for all G, $\mathrm{H}^0(G, \mathbb{Z}) = \mathbb{Z} \neq 0$.

Example 1.26

$G = \langle t \rangle$ infinite cyclic is of cohomological dimension 1 (over $\mathbb{Z}$).

An exercise is to show that if G is a free group of finite rank, then it is also of cohomological dimension 1. To see this, the Cayley graph is a tree and we can construct a resultion using this.

Remark 1.27. The converse is true. A finitely generated group of cohomological dimension 1 is free. In fact, this is true in general. See [Stallings, 1968], Swan, 1969.

Now consider the bar resolution in our definition of cohomology. Note that

$$\mathrm{Hom}_G(\mathbb{Z}G\{G^{(n)}\}, M) \cong C^n(G, M) = \left\{\text{functions } G^{(n)} \to M\right\}$$

This is the same as function $G^n \to M$. We also have that

$$C^0(G, M) = \{\text{functions } [] \to M\} = M$$

Definition 1.28

The group of *n-cochains* of G with coefficients in M is $C^n(G, M)$. The *n-coboundary map*

$$\mathrm{d}^n : C^{n-1}(G, M) \to C^n(G, M)$$

is dual to d_n in the bar resolution. For $\phi \in C^{n-1}(G, M)$,

$$\begin{aligned}(\mathrm{d}^n\phi)(g_1, \dots, g_n) = {} & g_1\phi(g_2, \dots, g_n) \\ & - \phi(g_1g_2, \dots, g_n) \\ & + \phi(g_1, g_2g_3, \dots, g_n) \\ & + \dots \\ & + (-1)^{n-1}\phi(g_1, g_2, \dots, g_{n-1}g_n) \\ & + (-1)^n\phi(g_1, g_2, \dots, g_{n-1})\end{aligned}$$

The group of *n-cocycles* is $Z^n(G, M) = \ker(\mathrm{d}^{n+1}) \subseteq C^n(G, M)$, and the *n-coboundaries* is $B^n(G, M) = \mathrm{im}(\mathrm{d}^n) \subseteq C^n(G, M)$.

Thus,

$$\mathrm{H}^n(G, M) = \frac{Z^n(G, M)}{B^n(G, M)}$$

Corollary 1.29. For any group G, $\mathrm{H}^0(G, M) = M^G$ is the invariants.

Definition 1.30

A *derivation of G with coefficients in M* is a function $\phi : G \to M$, such that

$$\phi(gh) = g\phi(h) + \phi(g)$$

Note that $Z^1(G, M)$ is the set of derivations. Also note that these are also called 'crossed homomorphisms'.

An *inner derivation* is ϕ of the form

$$\phi(g) = gm - m$$

for a fixed $m \in M$.

Corollary 1.31.

$$\mathrm{H}^1(G, M) = \frac{\{\text{derivations } G \to M\}}{\{\text{inner derivations} G \to M\}}$$

In particular, if M is a trivial $\mathbb{Z}G$-module, then

$$\mathrm{H}^1(G, M) = \mathrm{Hom}_{\mathrm{Group}}(G, M)$$

We will return to considering homology arising from different resolutions.

Definition 1.32

Let $(A_n, \alpha_n), (B_n, \beta_n)$ be chain complexes of $\mathbb{Z}G$-modules, a *chain map* $f = (f_n)$ are $\mathbb{Z}G$-maps $f_n : A_n \to B_n$, such that

$$\begin{array}{ccc} A_n & \xrightarrow{\alpha_n} & A_{n-1} \\ {\scriptstyle f_n}\downarrow & & \downarrow{\scriptstyle f_{n-1}} \\ B_n & \xrightarrow[\beta_n]{} & B_{n-1} \end{array}$$

commutes.

Lemma 1.33. Given a chain map (f_n), it induces a map on homology groups

$$f_* : \mathrm{H}_n(A_\bullet) \to \mathrm{H}_n(B_\bullet)$$

Lecture 4

Proof. Let $x \in \ker(\alpha_n)$. Define $f_*([x]) = [f_n(x)]$, where $[\cdot]$ denotes a homology class. Observe that

$$f_n(x) \in \ker(\beta_n)$$

since $\beta_n(f_n(x)) = f_{n-1}(\alpha_n(x)) = 0$. Moreover, if $x' = x + \alpha_{n-1}(y)$, then

$$f_n(x') = f_n(x) + f_n(\alpha_{n-1}(y)) = f_n(x) + \beta_n(f_n(y))$$

and so $[f_n(x')] = [f_n(x)]$. Moreover, this gives a map of abelian groups. □

Theorem 1.34. The definition of $\mathrm{H}^n(G, M)$ is independent of the choice of projective resolution.

Proof. Take projective resolutions (P_n, d_n) and (P'_n, d'_n) of $\mathbb{Z}$ by $\mathbb{Z}G$-modules. We will produce

- chain maps $f_n : P_n \to P'_n$, $g_n : P'_n \to P_n$,
- chain homotopies $s_n : P_n \to P_{n+1}$, $s'_n : P'_n \to P'_{n+1}$,

That is,

$$\mathrm{d}s + s\mathrm{d} = gf - \mathrm{id} \quad \text{and} \quad \mathrm{d}s' + s'\mathrm{d} = fg - \mathrm{id}$$

Using this data, the f_n define chain maps

$$f^* : \mathrm{Hom}_G(P'_n, M) \to \mathrm{Hom}_G(P_n, M) \quad \text{and} \quad g^* : \mathrm{Hom}_G(P'_n, M) \to \mathrm{Hom}_G(P_n, M)$$

which induce maps between the respective homology groups. Now observe if $\phi \in \ker(\mathrm{d}^{n+1}) \in \mathrm{Hom}(P_n, M)$, then

$$\begin{aligned} f^*g^*(\phi)(x) &= \phi(g(f(x))) \\ &= \phi(x) + \phi(\mathrm{d}s(x)) + \phi(s\,\mathrm{d}(x)) \\ &= \phi(x) + s^*\mathrm{d}\phi(x) + \mathrm{d}s^*\phi(x) \\ &= \phi(x) + \mathrm{d}s^*\phi(x) \end{aligned}$$

and so $f^*g^*(\phi) = \phi + \mathrm{d}(s^*\phi)$. Hence f^*g^* induces the identity map on homology. Similarly, g^*f^* also induce the identity map. This, f^*, g^* yield isomorphisms on homology. It remains to construct the maps as above.

Consider the end of the resolutions, so we have $f_{-1} : \mathbb{Z} \to \mathbb{Z}$ which is the identity map, and $f_{-2} : 0 \to 0$ is the zero map. Suppose we have already defined f_{n-1}, f_n. We would like to construct f_{n+1}. Thus, $f_n\mathrm{d} : P_{n+1} \to P'_n$, and $\mathrm{d}'(f\mathrm{d}) = f\mathrm{dd} = 0$. Thus, the map $f\mathrm{d}$ has image contained in $\ker(\mathrm{d}')$. So we can define f_{n+1} as follows:

$$\begin{array}{ccccccc}
 & & P_{n+1} & \xrightarrow{\mathrm{d}} & P_n & \xrightarrow{\mathrm{d}} & P_{n-1} \\
 & \overset{f_{n+1}}{\swarrow} & \downarrow{\scriptstyle f_n\mathrm{d}} & & \downarrow{\scriptstyle f_n} & & \downarrow{\scriptstyle f_{n-1}} \\
P'_{n+1} & \twoheadrightarrow & \ker(\mathrm{d}') & \hookrightarrow & P'_n & \xrightarrow[\mathrm{d}']{} & P_{n-1}
\end{array}$$

Here, by exactness the map $P'_{n+1} \to \ker(\mathrm{d}')$ is surjective, and so as P'_{n+1} is projective, such a map exists. We can define g_n similarly.

To define s_n, set $h_n = g_n f_n - \mathrm{id}$. This is a map from P_n to itself. In particular, h_n is a chain map, with $h_{-1} = 0$. Set $s_{-1} : \mathbb{Z} \to P_0$ to be the zero map, and note $\mathrm{d}_0 h_0 = h_{-1}\mathrm{d}_0 = 0$, and so $\mathrm{im}(h_0) \subseteq \ker(d_0)$. As before, $\mathrm{d}_1 : P_1 \to \ker(\mathrm{d}_0)$ is surjective, and so we have

$$\begin{array}{ccccccc}
 & & & & P_0 & \longrightarrow & \mathbb{Z} \\
 & & \overset{s_0}{\swarrow} & \overset{h_0}{\searrow} & \downarrow{\scriptstyle h_0} & & \downarrow{\scriptstyle 0} \\
P_1 & \twoheadrightarrow & \ker(\mathrm{d}) & \longrightarrow & P_0 & \longrightarrow & \mathbb{Z}
\end{array}$$

Inductively, suppose s_{n-1}, s_{n-2} are already defined, set $t_n = h_n - s_{n-1}\mathrm{d}_n : P_n \to P_n$. We have that

$$\begin{aligned}
\mathrm{d}_n t_n &= \mathrm{d}_n h_n - \mathrm{d}_n s_{n-1}\mathrm{d}_n \\
&= h_{n-1}\mathrm{d}_n - (h_{n-1} - s_{n-2}\mathrm{d}_{n-1})\mathrm{d}_n \\
&= s_{n-2}\mathrm{d}_{n-1}\mathrm{d}_n \\
&= 0
\end{aligned}$$

So $\mathrm{im}(t_n) \subseteq \ker(\mathrm{d}_n)$. So we have[1]

$$\begin{array}{ccccccc}
 & & P_n & & \xrightarrow{\mathrm{d}_n} & & P_{n-1} \\
 & \overset{s_n}{\swarrow} & \downarrow{\scriptstyle t_n} & \overset{h_n}{\searrow} & & \overset{s_{n-1}}{\swarrow} & \overset{h_{n-1}}{\searrow} \\
P_{n+1} & \twoheadrightarrow & \ker(\mathrm{d}_n) & \hookrightarrow & P_n & \xrightarrow{\mathrm{d}_n} & P_{n-1}
\end{array}$$

Define s'_n similarly and we are done. □

Remark 1.35. For any (left) $\mathbb{Z}G$-module N, we can take a projective (resp. free) resolution of N by $\mathbb{Z}G$-modules. Repeating everything we have done, and applying $\mathrm{Hom}_G(\cdot, M)$ gives homology groups, which are called

$$\mathrm{Ext}^n_{\mathbb{Z}G}(N, M)$$

and so

$$\mathrm{H}^n(G, M) = \mathrm{Ext}^n_{\mathbb{Z}G}(\mathbb{Z}, M)$$

As above, the Ext-groups are independent of resolution.

2 Low degree cohomology, group extensions

2.1 First cohomology

Recall that $\mathrm{H}^0(G, M) = M^G$ is the group of invariants under G, and that a derivation (or a 1-cocycle) is a map $\phi : G \to M$, such that

$$\phi(g_1 g_2) = g_1\phi(g_2) + \phi(g_1)$$

[1] THIS DIAGRAM DOES NOT COMMUTE!

We will see two interpretations of (inner) derivations. Recall that an inner derivation is one of the form $\phi(g) = gm - m$, for some fixed $m \in M$.

Let M be a $\mathbb{Z}G$-module, and consider possible $\mathbb{Z}G$-actions on the abelian group $M \oplus \mathbb{Z}$ of the form

$$g(m, n) = (gm + n\phi(g), n)$$

In this case,

$$g_1 g_2(m, n) = g_1(g_2 m + n\phi(g_2), n) = (g_1 g_2 m + n g_1 \phi(g_2) + n\phi(g_1), n)$$

On the other hand,

$$(g_1 g_2)(m, n) = (g_1 g_2 m + n\phi(g_1 g_2), n)$$

These are the same exactly when ϕ is a derivation. In particular, if M is a free $\mathbb{Z}$-module of finite rank, then we get a map $G \to \mathrm{GL}(M)$, by can write this as

$$g \mapsto \begin{pmatrix} \theta_1(g) & \mathrm{d}g \\ 0 & 1 \end{pmatrix}$$

where $\theta_1(g)$ is the action of g on M. In particular, this is a homomorphism of groups if and only if ϕ is a derivation. Moreover, ϕ is an inner derivation if and only if $(-m, 1)$ generates a $\mathbb{Z}G$-submodule which is a trivial module inside $M \oplus \mathbb{Z}$.

Lecture 5

For the second interpretation:

Definition 2.1 (semidirect product)

Let G be a group, M be a $\mathbb{Z}G$-module. We can construct their *semidirect product* $M \rtimes G$ as a group $M \times G$ with operation

$$(m_1, g_1) * (m_2, g_2) = (m_1 + g_1 m_2, g_1 g_2)$$

Here, we have an isomorphism

$$M \cong \{(m, 1) \mid m \in M\}$$

This is an abelian normal subgroup. Similarly, we have an isomorphism

$$G \cong \{(0, g) \mid g \in G\}$$

and conjugation by $\{(0, g)\}$ corresponds to the G-action on M.

Moreover,

$$\frac{M \rtimes G}{\{(m, 1) \mid m \in M\}} \cong G$$

Note that there is a group homomorphism $s : G \to M \rtimes G$, $s(g) = (0, g)$ is such that

$$G \to M \rtimes G \to G$$

is the identity. s is called a *splitting*. Now if we have another splitting $s_1 : G \to M \rtimes G$, so that the composition $G \to M \rtimes G \to G$ is the identity. Define $\psi_{s_1} : G \to M$, so that

$$s_1(g) = (\psi_{s_1}(g), g)$$

Then $\psi_{s_1} \in Z^1(G, M)$, and given two splittings s_1, s_2, $\psi_{s_1} - \psi_{s_2} \in B^1(G, M)$ if and only if there exists an m such that

$$(m, 1)s_1(g)(m_1)^{-1} = s_2(g)$$

Conversely, given $\phi \in Z^1(G, M)$, there exists a splitting s_1 such that $\phi = \psi_{s_1}$.

Theorem 2.2. $\mathrm{H}^1(G, M)$ correspond to the M-conjugacy classes of splittings.

Proof. Examples Sheet 1. □

2.2 Second cohomology

Definition 2.3 (extension)

An *extension* E of G by M for a group G, and a $\mathbb{Z}G$-module M, is an exact sequence

$$0 \longrightarrow M \longrightarrow E \longrightarrow G \longrightarrow 1$$

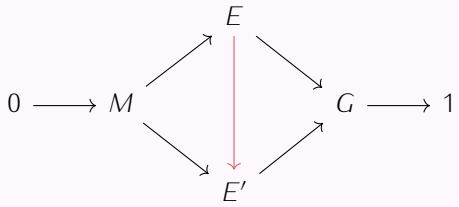
where the maps are group homomorphisms. That is, M embeds in E, so that the image M is an abelian normal subgroup. E acts on M by conjugation, and as M is abelian, we have an induced action on $E/M \cong G$. This agrees with the given G-action on M.

Example 2.4

$E = M \rtimes G$ is an extension of G by M. This is called the *split extension*.

Definition 2.5 (equivalent)

Two extensions are *equivalent* if we have a commuting diagram of group homomorphisms



Remark 2.6. The vertical map is an isomorphism of groups. However, the converse is false. On examples sheet 1, we have E, E' isomorphic groups, but inequivalent extensions.

Definition 2.7 (central extension)

A *central* extension is one where the $\mathbb{Z}G$-module is a trivial module.

Proposition 2.8. Let E be an extension of G by M. If there exists a splitting $s_1 : G \to E$, then E is equivalent to $M \rtimes G$.

Proof. Exercise. □

Theorem 2.9. Let G be a group, and M be a $\mathbb{Z}G$-module. Then there exists a bijection between $\mathrm{H}^2(G, M)$ and the equivalence classes of extensions of G by M.

Given an extenstion

$$0 \longrightarrow M \longrightarrow E \longrightarrow G \longrightarrow 1$$

a *section* is a function $s : G \to E$, such that the composition $\pi \circ s = \mathrm{id}$, where π is the map $E \to G$. Note that s need not be a group homomorphism. Suppose $s(1) = 1$. Let

$$\phi(g_1, g_2) = s(g_1)s(g_2)s(g_1g_2)^{-1}$$

Then

$$\pi(\phi(g_1g_2)) = 1$$

and so $\phi(g_1, g_2) \in \ker(\pi) = M$. That is, we have a map $\phi : G^2 \to M$, which is a 2-cochain. In fact, it is a 2-cocycle.

$$\begin{aligned} s(g_1)s(g_2)s(g_2) &= \phi(g_1, g_2)s(g_1g_2)s(g_3) \\ &= \phi(g_1, g_2)\phi(g_1g_2, g_3)s(g_1g_2g_3) \end{aligned} \tag{$*$}$$

Similarly,

$$\begin{aligned} s(g_1)s(g_2)s(g_3) &= s(g_1)\phi(g_2, g_2)s(g_2g_3) \\ &= s(g_1)\phi(g_2g_3)s(g_1)^{-1}s(g_1)s(g_2g_3) \\ &= s(g_1)\phi(g_2g_2)s(g_1)^{-1}\phi(g_1, g_2g_3)s(g_1g_2g_3) \end{aligned} \tag{$**$}$$

Equating $(*)$ and $(**)$, cancelling the $s(g_1g_2g_3)$, and changing into additive notation, we get

$$\phi(g_1, g_2) + \phi(g_1g_2, g_3) = g_1\phi(g_2, g_3) + \phi(g_1, g_2g_3)$$

Hence

$$\mathrm{d}\phi(g_1, g_2, g_3) = 0$$

and so $\phi \in Z^2(G, M)$. Note ϕ is *normalised*. That is, $\phi(1, g) = \phi(g, 1) = 0$. So what we have shown is that an extension of G by M, along with a choice of section s, yields a normalised 2-cocycle $\phi \in Z^2(G, M)$.

Now take another choice of section s', with $s'(1) = 1$. Then the corresponding normalised cocycles ϕ and ϕ' differ by a coboundary, and so we have defined a map

$$\{\text{extensions}\} \to \mathrm{H}^2(G, M)$$

Lecture 6

To see this, note that $\pi(s(g)s'(g)^{-1}) = 1$, and $\psi(g) = s(g)s'(g)^{-1} \in \ker(\pi) = M$. Thus, we have a map $\psi : G \to M$. Then

$$\begin{aligned} s'(g_1)s'(g_2) &= \psi(g_1)s(g_1)\psi(g_2)s(g_2) \\ &= \psi(g_1)s(g_1)\psi(g_2)s(g_1)^{-1}s(g_1)s(g_2) \\ &= \psi(g_1)s(g_1)\psi(g_2)s(g_1)^{-1}\phi(g_1, g_2)s(g_1g_2) \\ &= \psi(g_1)s(g_1)\psi(g_2)s(g_2)^{-1}\phi(g_1, g_2)\psi(g_1g_2)^{-1}s'(g_1g_2) \end{aligned}$$

Switching to additive notation:

$$\begin{aligned} \phi'(g_1, g_2) &= \psi(g_1) + g_1\psi(g_2) + \phi(g_1, g_2) - \psi(g_1g_2) \\ &= \phi(g_1, g_2) + \mathrm{d}\psi(g_1, g_2) \end{aligned}$$

Thus, ϕ and ϕ' differ by a coboundary. For the rest of the proof, we need:

(a) to show that equivalent extensions give the same cohomology class,

(b) construct an inverse map from cohomology classes to extensions,

(c) show that the two maps are inverse to each other.

We will show (b), and leave (a) and (c). For this, we need

Lemma 2.10. Let $\phi \in Z^2(G, M)$. Then there exists a cochain $\psi \in C^1(G, M)$, such that $\phi + \mathrm{d}\psi$ is a normalised cocycle. Hence every cohomology class can be reresented by a normalised cocycle.

Proof. Let $\psi(g) = -\phi(1, g)$. Then

$$(\phi + \mathrm{d}\psi)(1, g) = \phi(1, g) - (\phi(1, g) - \phi(1, g) + \phi(1, 1)) = \phi(1, g) - \phi(1, 1)$$

and

$$(\phi + \mathrm{d}\psi)(g, 1) = \phi(g, 1) - g\phi(1, 1)$$

But we know that $\mathrm{d}\phi(1, 1, g) = \mathrm{d}\phi(g, 1, 1) = 0$ as ϕ is a cocycle. A computation shows that both of the above are zero. □

Now take a normalised cocycle ϕ representating our cohomology class. We construct an extension as follows.

$$0 \longrightarrow M \longrightarrow E_\phi \longrightarrow G \longrightarrow 1$$

by considering $E = M \times G$, with the product structure

$$(m_1, g_1)(m_2, g_2) = (m_1 + g_1 m_2 + \phi(g_1, g_2), g_1 g_2)$$

For this to be a group operation, we use that ϕ is normalised. In this case, we do have an extension, where the map π is projection onto the second factor. Notice if we have another normalised 2-cocycle ϕ' representing our cohomology class, then $\phi - \phi' = \mathrm{d}\psi$ is a coboundary, and we can define a map

$$\begin{aligned} E_\phi &\to E_{\phi'} \\ (m, g) &\mapsto (m + \psi(g), g) \end{aligned}$$

This gives us an equivalence of extensions.

Example 2.11 (central extensions of $\mathbb{Z}^2$ by $\mathbb{Z}$)

Note we already know of (at least) two such. We could have

$$0 \longrightarrow \mathbb{Z} \longrightarrow \mathbb{Z} \oplus \mathbb{Z}^2 \longrightarrow \mathbb{Z}^2 \longrightarrow 0$$

and we also have the Heisenberg group

$$H = \left\{ \begin{pmatrix} 1 & r & m \\ & 1 & s \\ & & 1 \end{pmatrix} \;\middle|\; r, s, m \in \mathbb{Z} \right\}$$

and we have an extension given by

$$\begin{aligned} m &\mapsto \begin{pmatrix} 1 & 0 & m \\ & 1 & 0 \\ & & 1 \end{pmatrix} \\ \begin{pmatrix} 1 & r & 0 \\ & 1 & 0 \\ & & 1 \end{pmatrix} &\mapsto (r, s) \end{aligned}$$

Now if we write things multiplicatively, $T \cong \mathbb{Z}^2$ is generated by a, b. We have a free resolution

$$0 \longrightarrow \mathbb{Z}T \xrightarrow{\beta} (\mathbb{Z}T)^2 \xrightarrow{\alpha} \mathbb{Z}T \xrightarrow{\varepsilon} \mathbb{Z} \longrightarrow 0$$

where

$$\begin{aligned} \beta(z) &= (z(1-b), z(a-1)) \\ \alpha(x, y) &= x(a-1) + y(b-1) \end{aligned}$$

and ε is the augmentation map. Now applying $\mathrm{Hom}_T(\cdot, \mathbb{Z})$, we get the chain complex

$$\mathrm{Hom}_T(\mathbb{Z}T, \mathbb{Z}) \xrightarrow{\alpha^*} \mathrm{Hom}_T((\mathbb{Z}T)^2, \mathbb{Z}) \xrightarrow{\beta^*} \mathrm{Hom}_T(\mathbb{Z}T, \mathbb{Z}) \longrightarrow 0$$

In fact, α^*, β^* are the zero maps, and so $\mathrm{H}^2(T, \mathbb{Z}) = \mathrm{Hom}_T(\mathbb{Z}T, \mathbb{Z}) \cong \mathbb{Z}$, with generator corresponding to the augmentation map $\varepsilon : \mathbb{Z}T \to \mathbb{Z}$.

To see that α^*, β^* are zero, take a $\mathbb{Z}T$-map $f : (\mathbb{Z}T)^2 \to \mathbb{Z}$ and $z \in \mathbb{Z}T$, then

$$\begin{aligned} (\beta^* f)(z) &= f(\beta(z)) \\ &= f(z(1-b), z(a-1)) \\ &= f(z - bz, 0) + f(0, za - z) \\ &= (1-b) f(z, 0) + (a-1) f(0, z) = 0 \end{aligned}$$

The proof that α^* is zero is similar.

Next, we will interpret $\mathrm{H}^2(T,\mathbb{Z})$ in terms of cocycles from the bar resolution. We will construct a chain map

$$\begin{array}{ccccccccc}
\mathbb{Z}T\{T^{(2)}\} & \longrightarrow & \mathbb{Z}T\{T^{(1)}\} & \longrightarrow & \mathbb{Z}T\{T^{(0)}\} & \xrightarrow{\varepsilon} & \mathbb{Z} & \longrightarrow & 0 \\
\downarrow{\scriptstyle f_2} & & \downarrow{\scriptstyle f_1} & & \downarrow{\scriptstyle \mathrm{id}} & & \downarrow{\scriptstyle =} & & \\
\mathbb{Z}T & \xrightarrow[\beta]{} & (\mathbb{Z}T)^2 & \xrightarrow[\alpha]{} & \mathbb{Z}T & \longrightarrow & \mathbb{Z} & \longrightarrow & 0
\end{array}$$

Note that for degrees -1 and 0, we can just take the identity map. To construct $f_1 : \mathbb{Z}T\{T^{(1)}\} \to (\mathbb{Z}T)^2$, we need that $\alpha f_1 = \mathrm{d}$. So we just need to define the image of the symbols $[a^r b^s]$, for $r, s \in \mathbb{Z}$. Say

$$f_1([a^r y^s]) = (x_{r,s}, y_{r,s})$$

and we need

$$\alpha(x_{r,s}, y_{r,s}) = \mathrm{d}^{a^r b^s} = a^r b^s - 1 = (a^r - 1)b^s + (b^s - 1)$$

Define

$$S(a,r) = \begin{cases} 1 + a + \cdots + a^{r-1} & r > 0 \\ -a^{-1} - \cdots - a^r & r \le 0 \end{cases}$$

We note that $S(a,r)(a-1) = a^r - 1$ in both cases. Then

$$\alpha(S(a,r)b^s, S(b,s)) = S(a,r)b^s(a-1) + S(b,s)(b-1) = \mathrm{d}^{a^r b^s}$$

as required. So we can define

$$f_1[a^r b^s] = (S(a,r)b^s, S(b,s))$$

Lecture 7

Example 2.12 (continued)

We need to define f_2. For each $[a^r b^s \mid a^t b^u]$, we find

$$z_{rstu} \in \mathbb{Z}T$$

such that

$$f_1 \mathrm{d}_2[a^r b^s \mid a^t b^u] = \beta(z_{rstu})$$

Note that

$$\begin{aligned} f_1 \mathrm{d}_2[a^r b^s \mid a^t b^u] &= f_1(a^r b^s [a^t b^u] - [a^{r+t} b^{s+u}] + [a^r b^s]) \\ &= a^r b^s S(a,t) b^u - S(a, r+t) b^{s+u} + S(a,r) b^s - a^r b^s S(b,u) - S(b, s+u) + S(b,s) \end{aligned}$$

Note that

$$z_{rstu} = S(a,r) b^s S(b,u)$$

works. So we define

$$f_2[a^r b^s \mid a^t b^u] = S(a,r) b^s S(b,u)$$

Now we find a cochain $\phi : T^2 \to \mathbb{Z}$ representing the cohomology class $p \in \mathbb{Z} = \mathrm{Hom}_T(\mathbb{Z}T, \mathbb{Z}) = \mathrm{H}^2(T,\mathbb{Z})$. Such a cochain is given by the composition

$$T^2 \xrightarrow{f_2} \mathbb{Z}T \xrightarrow{p\varepsilon} \mathbb{Z}, \qquad \phi = p\varepsilon f_2$$

Since $\varepsilon(S(a,r)) = r$, we find that

$$\phi(a^r b^s, a^t b^u) = p\varepsilon(z_{rstu}) = pru$$

The group structure on $\mathbb{Z} \times T$ correspnding to ϕ is

$$(m, a^r b^s)(n, a^t b^u) = (m + n + pru, a^{r+t} b^{s+u})$$

This corresponds to the group of matrices

$$\left\{ \begin{pmatrix} 1 & pr & m \\ 0 & 1 & s \\ 0 & 0 & 1 \end{pmatrix} \;\middle|\; r, s, m \in \mathbb{Z} \right\}$$

2.3 Group extensions by presentations

Another approach to consider (central) extensions is to use a partial resolution arising from generators and relations.

Let G be a group, and let X be a generating set. Then we have a canonical map $F = F(X) \twoheadrightarrow G$. Let R be the kernel. Then we have a short exact sequence

$$1 \longrightarrow R \longrightarrow F \longrightarrow G \longrightarrow 1$$

which is the presentation of G. The subgroup R can be thought of as the set of relations. Now $R \trianglelefteq F$, and so F acts on R by conjugation. Often we take a set of generators of R as a normal subgroup for F.

Let $R_{\text{ab}} = R/[R, R]$ be the abelianisation of R. It inherits an action of F, but R acts trivially on R_{ab}, and so we ahve an induced action by $G = F/R$. Thus, R_{ab} is a $\mathbb{Z}G$-module, called the *relation module*.

Associated to this is an extension

$$1 \longrightarrow R_{\text{ab}} \longrightarrow F/[R, R] \longrightarrow G \longrightarrow 1$$

For a central extension, we need

$$1 \longrightarrow R/[R, F] \longrightarrow F/[R, F] \longrightarrow G \longrightarrow 1$$

Unfortunately, there isn't a largest (or univeral) central extension, since we can always form direct products with an abelian group. The central extension above does have good properties.

Theorem 2.13 (MacLane)**.** Given a presentation of G, let M be a left $\mathbb{Z}G$-module. Then there is an exact sequence

$$\mathrm{H}^1(F, M) \longrightarrow \mathrm{Hom}_G(R_{\text{ab}}, M) \longrightarrow \mathrm{H}^2(G, M) \longrightarrow 0$$

Thus, any equivalence class of extensions of G by M corresponding to a cohomology class, arises from a $\mathbb{Z}G$-map $R_{\text{ab}} \to M$.

Note that M is a $\mathbb{Z}F$-module, via the map $F \to G$.

Corollary 2.14. In the above, if M is a trivial module, then we have

$$\mathrm{Hom}(F, M) \longrightarrow \mathrm{Hom}_G(R/[R, F], M) \longrightarrow \mathrm{H}^2(G, M) \longrightarrow 0$$

Proof. M is a trivial $\mathbb{Z}F$-module, and so $\mathrm{H}^1(F, M) = \mathrm{Hom}(F, M)$ which are the group homomorphisms to an abelian group, which factors through the abelianisation. So $\mathrm{H}^1(F, M) = \mathrm{Hom}(F_{\text{ab}}, M)$.

Similarly, $\mathrm{Hom}_G(R_{\text{ab}}, M) = \mathrm{Hom}_G(R/[R, F], M)$. □

There is also a connection with homology groups. Given a projective resolution of the trivial $\mathbb{Z}G$-module $\mathbb{Z}$, instead of applying $\mathrm{Hom}(\cdot, M)$, we can apply the functor $\mathbb{Z} \otimes_{\mathbb{Z}G} \cdot$. We get a chain complex, and we can define the associated homology groups.

The homology groups don't depend on the choice of resolution. We will write the homology groups as $\mathrm{H}_n(G; \mathbb{Z})$.

Definition 2.15 (Schur multiplier)
The *Schur multiplier (or multiplicator)* is $M(G) = H_2(G;\mathbb{Z})$.

This is important for studying central extensions.

Theorem 2.16 (universal coefficient)**.** Let G be a group, and M be a trivial $\mathbb{Z}G$-module. Then there is a short exact sequence

$$0 \longrightarrow \mathrm{Ext}^1(G_{ab}, M) \longrightarrow H^2(G, M) \longrightarrow \mathrm{Hom}(M(G), M) \longrightarrow 0$$

where $\mathrm{Ext}^1(G_{ab}, M)$ arises by applying $\mathrm{Hom}_{\mathbb{Z}}(\cdot, M)$ to a projective resolution of an abelian group G_{ab}.

Corollary 2.17. Suppose $G = [G, G]$. Then $G_{ab} = 1$, and we get that

$$H^2(G, M) \cong \mathrm{Hom}(M(G), M)$$

Remark 2.18. Sometimes people define the Schur multiplier to be $H^2(G, \mathbb{C}^*)$ instead of $H_2(G;\mathbb{Z})$. Schur was considering projective representations, $G \to \mathrm{PGL}(\mathbb{C})$. Such a map lifts to a linear representation of a central extension of G.

There is a formula:

Theorem 2.19 (Hopf)**.** Given a presentation $G = F/R$,

$$M(G) = \frac{[F, F] \cap R}{[R, F]}$$

Note that this is not necessarily all of $F/[R, F]$.

Remark 2.20. This shows that $([F, F] \cap R)/[R, F]$ is independent of the choice of presentation.

Index

$\mathbb{Z}G$-map, 2

augmentation map, 2

chain complex, 3

exact, 3

free $\mathbb{Z}G$ module, 2

$\mathrm{Hom}_G(M, N)$, 2
homology, 3

integral group ring, 1

projective, 4

short exact sequence, 3

trivial $\mathbb{Z}G$ module, 2

$\mathbb{Z}G$ module, 1